

# Mega Menu Ideation Meeting

Meeting Notes & Action Items | July 3, 2026 | 3:15 PM | 1 hr 17 min

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## Attendees

| Name            | Role                                       |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Jerel Smith     | Senior PM, FIND Team (Host)                |
| Sam Herman      | Architect / Navigation Architecture        |
| Nachman Siegel  | Architect / Navigation Architecture        |
| Meilech Hiller  | Architect / Navigation Architecture        |
| Sumit Paul      | UX / Front-End Design                      |
| Yoel Porgesz    | UX / Front-End Design                      |
| Shimon (caller) | Architect (partial attendance)             |
| Ariel Listic    | Referenced / Not present (to be looped in) |

## Executive Summary

Jerel Smith facilitated an ideation session with the Navigation Architecture and UX teams to work through open technical and design questions for the Mega Menu redesign. The session covered six primary topic areas: (1) new-to-used category mapping, (2) Cable Finder integration and dynamic text, (3) featured category selection and sort order, (4) custom/landing-page URL support in featured slots, (5) WSM paid-placement and banner management inside the mega menu, and (6) mega menu positioning and responsive column rules. Several items require follow-up with Ariel Listic and a Part 2 session before architecture can proceed to grooming.

## Detailed Discussion Notes

### 1 New-to-Used Category Mapping

The team discussed whether an automated mapping exists to link new and used categories for display in the Mega Menu (Level 1 only for initial scope).

- A used-to-new mapping exists in the DES system but was originally built for a refinement carry-over script, not for front-end display.
- Ariel Listic has the deepest knowledge of this mapping and whether it can be reliably consumed by the website's mega menu.
- A UX concern was raised: the label "New" adjacent to "Used" could confuse customers (e.g., "New in Pro Video" vs. "New arrivals" vs. "Used"). Nachman Siegel noted this may need a simple label update (e.g., "New Arrivals").
- Manual population is considered a fallback if automated mapping cannot be confirmed before go-live.

### 2 Cable Finder Integration & Dynamic Text

The team explored how the Cable Finder link should appear in the mega menu and how to handle category-specific label text (e.g., "Find the perfect video cable" vs. "Find the perfect computer cable").

- Current state: Cable Finder JSP file is hard-coded and points to a specific refinement in the Cable Finder category. No dynamic category-based text exists.
- Three options discussed for label text:
  - Option A – Generic: Always display "Find the perfect cable" (simplest; may feel less contextual).
  - Option B – Hard-coded per category: Engineer a lookup map in code tying each of the ~11 categories to its specific label.
  - Option C – NavArc-entered text: Allow Nav Architecture team to manually enter cable finder link text via a business parameter in the DES (NavArc-only permission).
- Yoel's workaround suggestion: Could borrow the category label already present in the Cable Finder link URL to derive dynamic text programmatically.
- Meilech noted data in the DES *may* be workable, but reliability needs to be confirmed with Ariel Listic before committing.
- Nachman proposed a temporary workaround: manually create the 11 (or ~6 relevant) Cable Finder entries via Yoel's tool until a programmatic solution is ready.

### 3 Featured Category Selection & Sort Order

The featured slots (top positions in the left column of each mega menu panel) must shift from the current auto-populated first-N-categories behavior to manual, merchandiser-directed selection. Sort order within featured slots also requires a solution.

- Current behavior: Featured categories are driven automatically by the first items on a category page in the DES — not manually selected.
- Needed: A mechanism to tag specific categories as "Featured" in the DES Category Detail page (BH IA ticket scope). Previously discussed options include checkboxes or a dropdown toggle per category.
- Sort order within featured slots was confirmed as a required feature (e.g., prioritizing "Laptops" during back-to-school).
- Jerel referenced a prior solution document (PDF/prototype) agreed to by Sam Herman and architects that included drag-and-drop sequencing. This document needs to be located and recirculated before the Part 2 session.
- Nachman noted that the existing right promo zone in the DES already has up/down sort arrows, which could inform the featured sort UX.
- Sam clarified: standard category order changes (non-featured) would be handled via JIRA tickets to NavArc, not through any new tool.

### 4 Custom / Landing-Page URLs in Featured Slots

Discussion on whether the featured area should support non-category links (e.g., event landing pages such as "Fourth of July Specials").

- Current scope: Featured slots are Category ID (CI) only. Custom arbitrary URLs are not in scope.
- Sam Herman proposed a workaround: create a category with a redirect URL pointing to the desired landing page, preserving the CI-only architecture.
- Category rules (not just flat CI links) were confirmed as a supported mechanism — categories with applied rules/refinements are valid featured items.

- If a true custom URL is ever needed (e.g., Build Expo deals), it could be surfaced on the right-side panel via a new business parameter, not in the featured left-column slots.
- Decision deferred: full resolution requires Ariel Listic in the room.

## 5 WSM Paid Placement & Banner Management

How WSM (paid/sponsored) content and promotional banners should be managed inside the mega menu, including permissioning and visual balance.

- Current Explorer articles in the mega menu are driven by a tag in Explorer (per Jeremy Weiss), not a direct WSM feed.
- A paid-placement yes/no flag already exists in the right promotional zone of the DES — this could serve as a safeguard switch for the mega menu.
- Risk raised (Nachman): Allowing WSM banners to auto-populate the mega menu could result in visually overwhelming content that conflicts with the simplified, text-heavy mega menu layout. The existing concept visuals show very strong promotional imagery that may feel out of balance in a live context.
- Conflicting stakeholder directions identified:
  - One stakeholder direction: Every mega menu panel should have a consistent WSM banner.
  - Duran's direction: Reduce the ~300 annual UX requests from WSM to update mega menu content — WSM should not be generating that volume of change requests.
- Resolution path: Jerel to align with Duran, Lior, Sammy, and potentially Sijia (WSM ownership area) before any architectural decision is made on this workstream.

## 6 Mega Menu Positioning & Responsive Column Rules

Yoel Porgesz and Sumit Paul walked through the programmatic positioning rules for the mega menu flyout panel.

- Rule: If a nav category is on the LEFT side of the top navigation bar, the mega menu panel opens as far RIGHT as possible while still keeping the hovering category tab visible within the floating zone.
- Rule: If a nav category is on the RIGHT side, the panel opens as far LEFT as possible by the same logic.
- Column accommodation rule: The panel must accommodate up to 4 tiers of categories. If 4 tiers cannot fit on the originating side, the panel shifts to the opposite side.
- Consistency rule: Right-side mega menus will always pre-load at full 4-column width even when fewer columns are initially shown, to avoid panel bouncing/resizing as users drill into sub-categories.
- Exceptions: "Specialists" and possibly "More" categories do not follow the standard 4-column width rule.
- These rules are annotated in Sumit's design file (look for annotations labeled "mega"). Yoel recommended the rules be implemented programmatically rather than hard-coded per category.

## Open Questions

| # | Question                                                                                                                 | Owner                  |
|---|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| 1 | Can the existing new-to-used mapping in the DES be safely used for front-end mega menu display?                          | Ariel Listic           |
| 2 | Is the Cable Finder data in the DES reliable enough to drive dynamic label text (e.g., "video cable", "computer cable")? | Ariel Listic + Meilech |
| 3 | Where is the previously agreed-upon featured-sort prototype/PDF document? (Jerel to locate and recirculate.)             | Jerel Smith            |

|   |                                                                                                                        |                           |
|---|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| 4 | Should featured items support custom URL redirects via a category-with-redirect workaround?                            | Ariel Listic + Sam Herman |
| 5 | How should WSM banners in the mega menu be governed to prevent visual overload and reduce UX request volume?           | Jerel / Duran / Sija      |
| 6 | Does the paid-placement yes/no flag in the DES extend cleanly to mega menu context, or is a separate parameter needed? | Meilech / NavArc          |

## Action Items & Next Steps

| # | Action                                                                                                                                   | Owner                         | Target                          |
|---|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| 1 | Locate and recirculate the previously agreed-upon featured-sort prototype/PDF (drag-and-drop)                                            | Joel Smith                    | Before Part 2 (early next week) |
| 2 | Schedule Part 2 architecture session including Ariel Listic, Sam Herman, Nachman Siegel, Meilech Hiller, Sumit Paul, and Yoel Porgesz to | Jerel Smith                   | Monday next week                |
| 3 | Consult Ariel Listic on whether the existing new-to-used DES mapping can be used reliably for front-end display (Level 1 only)           | Ariel Listic (via Jerel)      | Part 2 session                  |
| 4 | Confirm with Ariel Listic whether Cable Finder data in DES can drive dynamic label for category.                                         | Ariel Listic + Meilech Hiller | Part 2 session                  |
| 5 | Evaluate updating "New" labels adjacent to "Used" categories to "New Arrivals" to prevent confusion.                                     | Sumit/Nachman Nachman Siegel  | Before go-live                  |
| 6 | Investigate adding permission controls to the DES business parameters so that merchandising directly                                     | Samy Herman / NavArc          | During grooming                 |
| 7 | Align with Duran, Lior, Sammy, and Sija on WSM banner governance for the mega menu — specifically                                        | Jerel Smith                   | Prior to Part 2 or concurrently |
| 8 | Review design file annotations labeled "mega" (Sumit's file) and confirm the program positioning rules for                               | Yoel Porgesz + Sumit Paul     | During grooming                 |
| 9 | Goal for Part 2 outcome: architecture team should leave that session with every thing needed from Product                                | Jerel Smith (facilitator)     | Part 2 session                  |

## Scope & Guardrails Confirmed in This Meeting

- Desktop only — no mobile changes in this initiative.
- Featured slots support Category IDs (CIs) and category rules only — no arbitrary custom URLs.
- Navigation order changes post-go-live handled via JIRA tickets to NavArc team; no new tooling required.
- Merchandising does NOT have direct DES/NavArc access for mega menu changes; all changes go through NavArc.
- Go-live plan: Launch new treatment, let it run 30 days before merchandising begins sending NavArc slot-change requests.
- WSM mega menu updates are NOT in scope for merchandising to self-serve; to be resolved in Duran/Sija alignment.

